

State of Alaska – Office of the Governor — 34th Alaska State Legislature – Second Session
DEPARTMENT REVIEW – PASSED LEGISLATION

BLUE SHEET

Blue Sheets are a department's final bill analysis and provides the Commissioner an opportunity to weigh in on legislation that has passed, with a recommendation to the Governor on action that may be taken– to enact the bill, to veto the bill, or to allow the bill to become Law without signature (LWOS). Much of the information requested in the Blue Sheet can be taken from the department's bill analyses (BA), which were initially submitted at the time the bill was introduced and updated throughout the legislative process.

Blue sheets are due to the GLO three days after the enrolled bill appears on basis, or sooner by request.

Department: DOH

Date: 5/26/2026

Bill Number: HB 73

Short Title (as it appears on BASIS): COMPLEX CARE RESIDENTIAL HOMES

What action do you recommend the Governor take?

Select one.

☒ SIGN ☐ VETO ☐ LWOS

Action Justification – Why do you recommend the above action?

Please be specific.

Alaska currently lacks the residential license type to appropriately serve these individuals, leading to placements in settings that are either too restrictive or not supportive enough. The new CCRH license type will fill a critical gap in residential care options in the state and improve health outcomes for Alaskans with complex needs

What does this Bill do?

In addition to providing a succinct bill summary, please also consider the following: Why is this bill needed? How does it specifically change department programs? What is the anticipated impact on the public, the private sector? Does this bill align with the priorities of Governor Dunleavy?

The bill establishes a new residential license type for Complex Care Residential Homes (CCRHs) to improve Alaska's system of care for individuals with complex behavioral health needs. CCRHs will provide long-term, supportive care in a residential setting for individuals with complex behavioral, and co-occurring medical, or disability-related needs.

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Detailed Sectional Analysis

The full sectional analysis of the bill should be completed by the lead agency. Other departments should include an analysis for sections of the bill affecting their agencies.

- Section 1.** Amends AS 47.32.010(b) to add "complex care residential homes" to the list of entities regulated by the Department of Health.
- Section 2.** Amends AS 47.32.900(2) to update the definition of "assisted living home" to exclude complex care residential homes.
- Section 3.** Adds AS 47.32.900(11) to modify the definition of "hospital" to clarify that it does not include complex care residential homes.
- Section 4.** Adds AS 47.32.900(22) to introduce a new definition for “complex care residential home.” It is defined as a residential setting that provides 24-hour multi-disciplinary care on a continuing basis for up to 15 individuals with mental, behavioral, medical, or disability-related needs requiring specialized care, services and monitoring.
- Section 5.** Amends the uncodified law by adding a new section that requires the Department of Health to submit for approval by the United States Department of Health and Human Services amendments to the state Medicaid plan or apply for waivers necessary to implement the provisions of Sections 1-4.
- Section 6.** Amends the uncodified law by adding a new section specifying that sections 1-4 of the bill will only take effect if the United States Department of Health and Human Services approves the required Medicaid waivers or amendments by July 1, 2031. The commissioner of health is required to notify the revisor of statutes within 30 days once the necessary approvals are received.
- Section 7.** Provides that sections 1-4 take effect the day after the United States Department of Health and Human Services approves amendments to the state plan or waivers submitted under Section 5.

Companion or Similar Bills

Please note companion legislation, the sponsor of the companion legislation, and identify any “rider” bills or provisions from other legislation that was included in this final bill. Please include the name of the sponsor of the “rider bill” or provision. If it was added as an amendment in a committee – please indicate the name of the legislator that sponsored the amendment.

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SB 76 Complex Care Residential Homes by the Governor is the companion bill.

Support/Opposition of the Bill

Please identify names, organizations, titles, and phones numbers of those who testified in support or in opposition of this bill.

Supporters:

Kara Nelson, Alaska Mental Health Board, 907-465-8920
Martin Lange, Alaska Commission on Aging 907-465-4793
Caitlin Poindexter & Patrick Reinhart, GCDSE, 907-269-8990
Jared Kosin, AHHA
Julia Luey, VOA Alaska, 907-279-9640
Shaun Keef, Central Peninsula Hospital, 907-714-4404
Robing Dempsey, Catholic Social Services, 907-222-7300
Shelley Ebenal, Foundation Health Partners

Bill Signing ceremony suggestions (if applicable)

Please provide information for consideration for a bill signing ceremony. Information that is helpful includes: a specific conference, event, venue, date, and the names and contact information of stakeholders who should be considered for an invitation to the bill signing ceremony.

Alaska Psychiatric Institute – atrium location
An assisted living center or hospital

Kara Nelson, Alaska Mental Health Board, 907-465-8920
Martin Lange, Alaska Commission on Aging 907-465-4793
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Robing Dempsey, Catholic Social Services, 907-222-7300
Shelley Ebenal, Foundation Health Partners

Commissioner's Signature: Heidi Hedberg Date: 5/26/2026

I have reviewed the above information and provided it to the Governor's Legislative Office for consideration of an action by the Governor on legislation passed during the second session of the 34th Alaska State Legislature.

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